The Weekend Bookmark

What caught my eye on X this week

17 OCTOBER 2026 · NO. 2

WEEKEND EDITION

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The machine that decides
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Recycling as penance
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The night-shift model

Users describe Opus 5.5 working unattended for 12 hours and going easy on quota; a summary of Anthropic's guide says to define a finish line.

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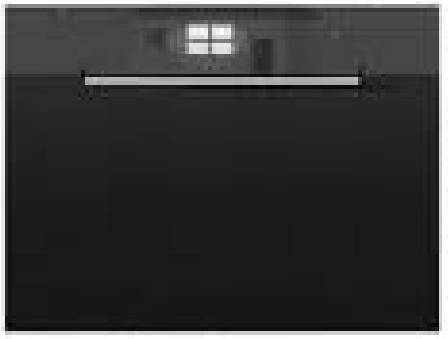
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QUOTE OF THE WEEK

"Companies are in some sense the original superintelligence."

Patrick Collison (@patrickc) · page 7

PRINTING THIS ISSUE

A4, double-sided, flip on long edge. To saddle-stitch, print as a booklet on four A3 sheets, flip on short edge, fold and staple twice.

The world this week

POLITICS FROM THE BOOKMARKS

Ulrich Siegmund (@UlrichSiegmund) wrote "Der Zeitplan steht - ab Dezember wird regiert." His post gives no coalition partners, ministers or other detail behind that timetable, and does not say who will govern where. @UlrichSiegmund

Christian Abel (@erdbeerbaegler), whose profile names the AfD, wrote that 51 per cent of women under 25 in Berlin voted for Die Linke. He cited no source, and the figure is unverified. @erdbeerbaegler

@mortalhope1 wrote that an Iranian-born doctor had announced he would leave Berlin because of what the post mockingly called the Islamist government elected the day before. The post's sole evidence is an image. @mortalhope1

Dr. Gunter Link (@mainstreamwatch) wrote that Hitler was "ein Linksradikaler reinsten Wassers", defending Alice Weidel, and cited a 2003 taz essay by Joachim Fest. Fest's essay is more hedged. @mainstreamwatch

Livia Clauss (@LiviaClauss) wrote "Das weitet sich zu einer Staatskrise aus." She shared a post pairing a 2022 Remmo photo in the Bundestag with Ferat Koçak's questions on police tactics against clans. @LiviaClauss

Austria introduced a €2 parcel tax per order in October, payable by mail-order retailers, wrote Mimi (@Mim_Tant). Sellers pass on €2.40, the post said, because VAT is added on top. @Mim_Tant

@rohit1a wrote that Opus 5.5 is very good at pushing 6.1 Sol to get work done, calling the combination "pure magic". @rohit1a

Jev's founder, described by @zodchiii as ex-OpenAI, said: "I believe JEV is the biggest breakthrough we've ever worked on". @zodchiii

Nathan Fielder (@nathanfielder) posted the official trailer for "You Can See Everything". Ed Elson (@edelson) shared it with a two-word verdict: "Holy sh*t". Fielder's post, as quoted, gave no release date or other detail. @nathanfielder

THE WEEKEND BOOKMARK
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BUSINESS FROM THE BOOKMARKS

Wulfie Bain (@wulfie_bain_) wrote that he is hiring in Munich for OpenAI's Applied AI team. The Codex-focused role involves working with top startups and pairing with a team of ex-founders and research engineers. @wulfie_bain_

Nvidia has open-sourced PersonaPlex-7B, a full-duplex conversational model that can listen and speak at once, Oliver Prompts (@oliviscusAI) wrote. The post said a dual-stream architecture lets it respond in real time. @oliviscusAI

SpaceX confirmed splashdown at the end of what it called Starship's first orbital flight, and congratulated the entire team. The company's post gave no further detail about the mission's profile or results. @SpaceX

0xhladoss (@stipme) wrote of stepping back from Zcash protocol work after years on cryptography including Halo and Orchard, saying Zcash "is not acting responsibly" and is "gambling with the financial system". @stipme

Satya Nadella (@satyanadella) published an essay on X titled "Models as Insider Risks in the Super Intelligence Era". His post carried only the title and a link to the full article. @satyanadella

OpenAI, which claims a Navier-Stokes solution, wrote that it never saw Levent Alpöge and Tristan Buckmaster's work before release, but cannot rule out de-identified data from their usage helping its models. @OpenAI

Alcuin Press (@AlcuinPress) posted an image captioned "C.S. Lewis, good people vs Christians", drawing 5,176 likes. The caption does not reproduce the passage, so its wording and its place in Lewis's writings cannot be checked here. @AlcuinPress

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SOFTWARE

Praise the delete key

AGENTS WRITE TOO MUCH; THE SCARCER SKILL IS CUTTING.

PROMPTED BY @pstein

Coding models are prolific, and prolixity has a cost. OpenClaw deleted around 400k lines of its own tests without much change in coverage; Peter Steinberger (@steipete) wrote that models "...just love writing tests for every tiny change, even if they aren't useful."[1] The skill that helped makes authors answer four questions before adding any test, and tells auditors to "optimize for confidence, not deletion count."[1] Nous Research (@NousResearch) pointed its agents at subtraction and shrank its non-test Python by 34.4 per cent, from 1,063,826 lines to 698,363.[2] The main run dispatched 1,393 subagents over about nineteen hours at an estimated model cost of about $29,300, against a manual estimate of $150k-$1.8M.[2] Community reviewers still caught regressions the existing tests had missed, including changed exception handling at roughly 65 sites, fixed before merge.[2] Teams should count lines removed as proudly as features shipped, and keep a human reading the diff. ■

SOURCES 1 @steipete tweet, 1x/2x3 2 @NousResearch tweet, 1x/2x2

ONLINE LAW

Protect the pseudonym

FIGHT ONLINE CRIME, BUT MAKE UNMASKING A JUDGE'S HARD CALL.

PROMPTED BY @MrAktien

Germany's draft law against digital violence rightly targets crime online. Yet, as Kolja Barghoorn (@MrAktien) wrote after studying the 102-page government draft, it would let courts order names, addresses, telephone numbers and IP data over certain criminal posts without a prior conviction.[1] User data could be secured by a court before a final decision on disclosure, and passed to prosecutors.[1] Judges must approve, he notes, and he calls that safeguard important.[1] That bar should be high: unmasking a pseudonym should need strong evidence of a crime, because anonymous criticism matters. Barghoorn asks what happens if such tools are used deliberately to bury inconvenient critics in proceedings, unmask them and limit their reach; a democracy, he wrote, must tolerate sharp and anonymous criticism.[1] ■

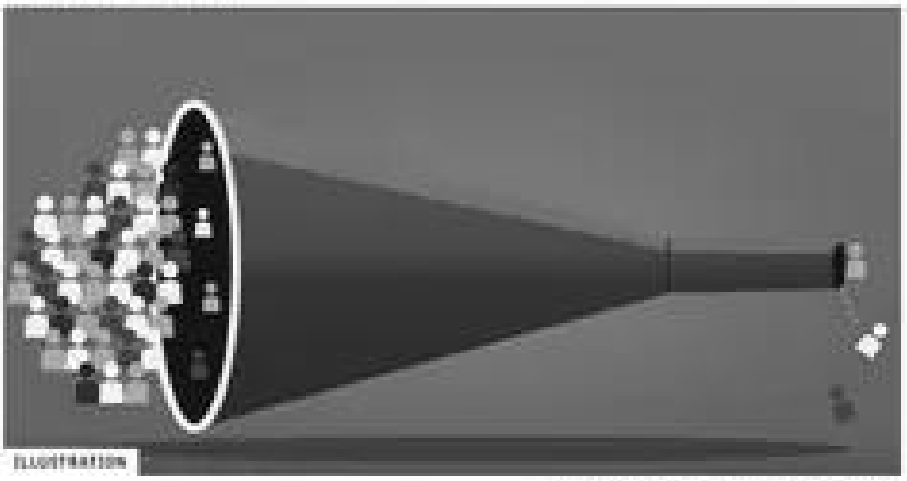
SOURCES 1 @MrAktien tweet, 1x/2x3

AI

Mind the funnel

AI'S REAL DIVIDE IS BETWEEN THE FEW WHO USE FRONTIER TOOLS AND THE BILLIONS WHO HAVE BARELY TOUCHED THEM; EMPLOYERS AND SCHOOLS SHOULD SPEND ACCORDINGLY.

PROMPTED BY @karpathy



ILLUSTRATION

ILLUSTRATION: AI-GENERATED FOR THIS ISSUE

Andrej Karpathy (@karpathy) wrote that the gap in shared understanding of what large language models can do is widening, and is now "more a sharp funnel" than a split.[1] By his napkin maths, around 6bn people, some 75 per cent of the population, have barely touched them; a further 20 per cent use free chatbots casually; about 0.2 per cent use frontier-grade models professionally for maths and code; and roughly 5,000 have internal access to frontier systems.[1] The majority of professionals, he wrote, "still see only a modest uplift", while "a small sliver of professionals are experiencing the vertigo of the curve going vertical".[1]

At the narrow end, a practitioner reports large gains. Yun-Ta Tsai (@yunta_tsai) wrote that his productivity with agentic tools is roughly 33 per cent higher than last year without them, and that concept to deliverable is roughly three times faster.[2] He warned that deploying them too early "only increases the velocity of slop".[2]

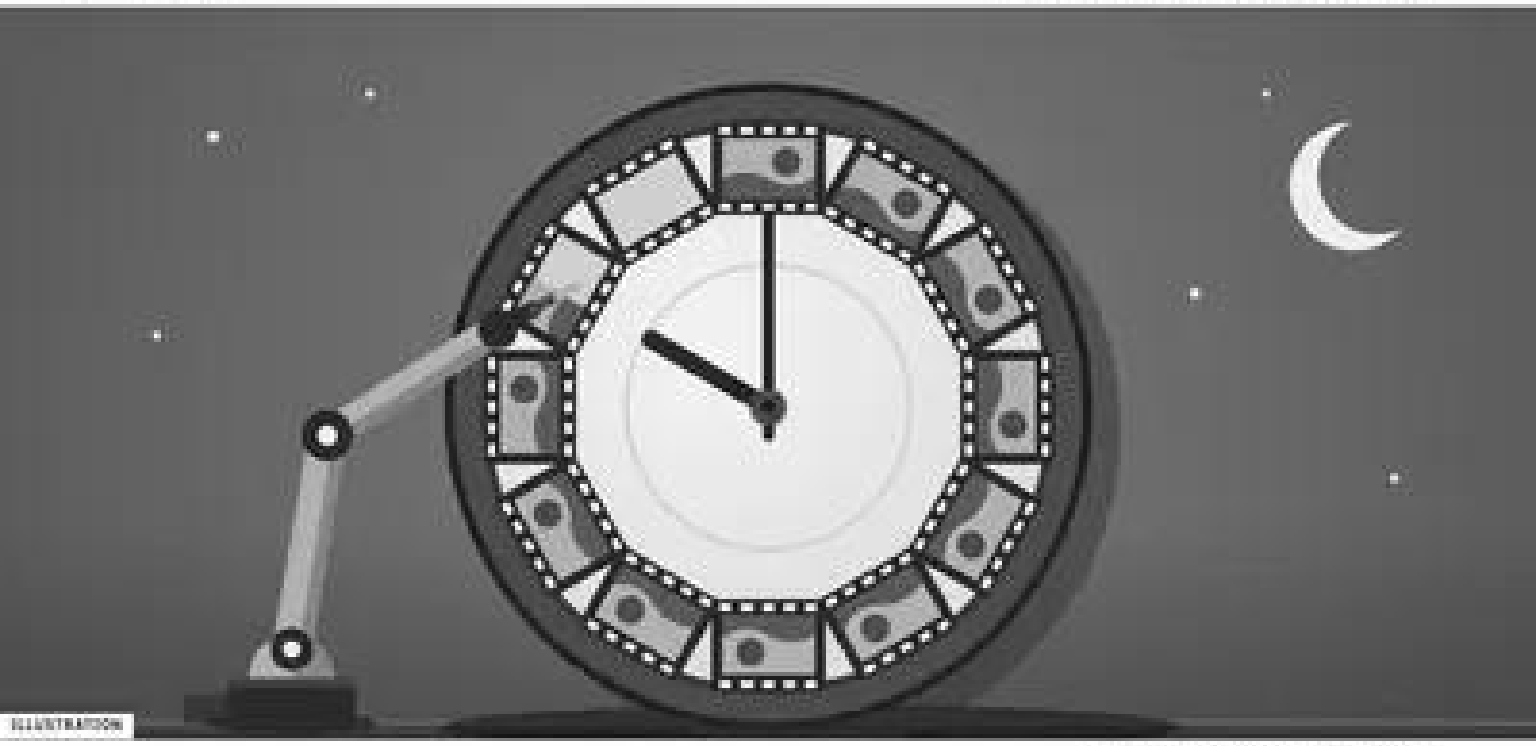
The bill, we think, is arriving at the wide end. Data from Revelio, charted by a16z, show global call-centre employment growth turning sharply negative after more than a decade of growth. Sharing the chart, @kimmonismus wrote that call-centre jobs grow about 4 per cent a year for 15 years and are now shrinking by 4 per cent a year.[3] The a16z note concedes that growth slowed when interest rates rose, and that stable American unemployment suggests former call-centre workers found jobs elsewhere; it still judges AI the likely driver.[3] The note adds that lower-middle-income countries stayed positive for longer, but that call-centre employment growth has since gone negative everywhere.[3]

The data do not say whether those workers used the tools. Karpathy wrote that the general public has mostly not interacted with these systems, and that when it has, "it looks like a derpy chatbot".[1] For executives, he added, it is "still second-hand and a bit abstract".[1] That, in our judgement, is the story: the clearest view of what the tools can do belongs to a narrow tip, while the costs land on work at the wide end.

Employers and schools should spend at the wide end. That means paid access and demanding problems for people outside engineering, not another seminar for staff who already run agents. Karpathy lists ambition, problem size and access among the causes; that reads like a budget.[1] So does Tsai's caution: tidy the process before automating it.[2] Understanding a tool after it has taken your job helps nobody. ■

SOURCES 1 @karpathy tweet, 1x/2x2 2 @yunta_tsai tweet, 1x/2x2 3 @kimmonismus tweet, 1x/2x8

THE ARGUMENT IN ONE LINE *AI understanding is now a funnel; widen its mouth rather than admire its tip.*



ILLUSTRATION

ILLUSTRATION: AI-GENERATED FOR THIS ISSUE

MODELS

Opus 5.5 is working the night shift

Users describe Opus 5.5 working unattended for 12 hours and going easy on quota; a summary of Anthropic's guide says to define a finish line.

SOURCED VIA @anabology

Late in September @anabology gave Opus 5.5 a borrowed prompt, Midjourney and a moodboard, then posted "12 hours later, woke up to this" above an image.[1] The post quoted another whose author wrote of speaking to a computer "for 5mins" while "claude worked for 12 hours".[1] Days later @anabology gave Claude "another 12 hours to one up this" and woke to a piece labelled "The Clodyssey".[2]

Thrift is another draw. The user signüll (@signulll) wrote of having "barely run into usage limits at all", and of the model "consuming dramatically less of my quota than other frontier models".[3] Compared with astra or sol, the post added, it was "night & day", and "the capability per token here feels kinda absurd".[3] These are impressions from users, not benchmarks: signüll's post began by asking how others had made the model so efficient.[3]

> *"the capability per token here feels kinda absurd, & this coming from anthropic"*
>
> SIGNÜLL (@SIGNULLL)

Part of the answer may be how people ask. Ole Lehmann (@itsolelehmann) summarised Anthropic's prompting guide, opening with advice to give autonomous tasks "an actual finish line": define what done looks like, such as all pages built and buttons tested, to reduce the stops where a user must type "continue".[5] He wrote that Anthropic found medium effort, now the default, matched or beat Opus 5 on high, and that maxing it out "mostly buys you slower, pricier replies".[5] He also advises deleting "think step by step", because Anthropic found that cutting such lines made replies faster with no drop in quality.[5]

Others share methods. Dan McAteer (@daniel_mac8) urged coders to run a prompt-audit command that, he wrote, "removes anti-patterns that restrict Opus 5.5" in files such as CLAUDE.md, crediting it to @RLanceMartin.[6] Florence (@flxrnc) wrote: "You no longer need After Effects if you use Claude Opus 5.5 correctly", and shared a PDF and an article on motion-design practice.[4]

Not every habit has gone. Mikeysee (@mikeysee) wrote that Opus 5.5 "has much less of the "Claudeisms" but its still there", and that a CLAUDE.md addition helps cut through "the Claude noise"; its "What I need from you" part usually "is all I need to get it going again".[7] Mikeysee has added something similar to Codex, whose summaries can leave it unclear what needs input.[7] A model that works through the night still needs telling what to report in the morning. ■

SOURCES 1 @anabology · bkmk.fo/2a3 · 2 @anabology · bkmk.fo/2a1 · 3 @signulll · bkmk.fo/2a3 · 4 @itsolelehmann · bkmk.fo/2a4 · 5 @daniel_mac8 · bkmk.fo/2a7 · 6 @flxrnc · bkmk.fo/2a6 · 7 @mikeysee · bkmk.fo/2a5

MODELS

The AI model that decides instead of chatting

JEV, A MODEL FROM TYPESAFE AI, ANSWERS TYPED QUESTIONS WITH PROBABILITIES RATHER THAN PROSE, AND BUILDERS ARE TRYING IT ON CODING SESSIONS AND SEARCH.

SOURCED VIA @CompleteSkeptic



PHOTO: @COMPLETESKEPTIC

Diogo Almeida (@CompleteSkeptic) wrote that after co-inventing ChatGPT he spent two years in stealth building a new kind of model.[1] It is Jev, TypeSafe AI's first public model.[1] Almeida calls it "optimized for decisions" and claims it is 20-200x faster and 40-400x cheaper, with output tokens free.[1]

Flavio Copes (@flaviocopes) described Jev as "a smart if statement": code sends data and typed questions; Jev returns choices, scores and probabilities.[2] TypeSafe says most calls take about 100 milliseconds; input costs $0.042 per million tokens.[2] Copes treats TypeSafe's headline multiples as a ceiling.[2] Jev cannot write a reply or explain its reasoning.[2]

@stevie_builds wrote Jev classifies questions "freakishly cheap and fast" and answers in code, not plain text.[3] Its example: give Jev a support ticket and ask which of three teams should help, how frustrated the user is and whether it is urgent.[3]

Kieran Klaassen (@kieranklaassen) uses Jev for non-black-box embeddings: instead of 1,536 numbers "that mean nothing", he asks Jev questions about each document and the answers become the vector.[4] Search then uses cosine similarity.[4] He wrote: "Every number has a name, so you can see why something matched."[4] ■

SOURCES 1 @CompleteSkeptic bkmk.to/201 2 @flaviocopes bkmk.to/202 3 @stevie_builds bkmk.to/203 4 @kieranklaassen bkmk.to/207

TRY IT THIS WEEKEND

1. Read Flavio Copes's explainer at flaviocopes.com/jev/, which walks through Jev's three question types with JavaScript examples and advises logging the versioned model ID that answered, then pinning it once your thresholds are tuned.
2. Claude Code users can install the fast-jev-compaction plugin from tamaratran on GitHub by setting CLAUDE_CODE_ENABLE_FUNCTION_HOOKS to 1 and adding TYPESAFE_API_KEY in settings, then adding the repository as a plugin marketplace, bearing in mind its own warning that a probability is not proof a result is safe to delete.
3. Rebuild the @stevie_builds example by asking Jev, in one request, which of three teams should take a support ticket, how frustrated the user is and whether it is urgent, phrasing yes-or-no questions so that a high value means yes, as Copes advises.

LABOUR

Call-centre jobs stop growing and start shrinking

REVELIO DATA SHOW GLOBAL CALL-CENTRE EMPLOYMENT FALLING AFTER MORE THAN A DECADE OF GROWTH.

SOURCED VIA @kimmonismus

Call-centre jobs grow about 4 per cent annually for 15 years and now shrink 4 per cent annually, @kimmonismus wrote, citing a16z.[1] Higher-income countries turned negative in 2022; lower-middle-income countries held out through most of 2024, but by late 2025 decline was universal.[1]

a16z calls AI the likely driver, though other causes are probable and the slowdown began with rising interest rates, slightly before GPT's release.[1] ■

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SOURCES 1 @kimmonismus bkmk.to/268

SCIENCE

Claude finds an enzyme system with no

ANTHROPIC SAYS THE SYSTEM, FOUND IN BACTERIOPHAGE DNA, RESEMBLES CRISPR, AND THE FEW KNOWN SYSTEMS SHARING ITS FEATURES CAN ALL CUT, COPY AND PASTE DNA.

SOURCED VIA @AnthropicAI

Anthropic (@AnthropicAI) wrote Claude has discovered a new enzyme system in bacteriophages, viruses that infect bacteria.[1] Roughly 950 agents searched for 21 hours; humans wrote the prompt and did lab work.[1] Called array-associated reverse transcriptases (ART), it pairs an enzyme with a partner gene and a CRISPR-like repeat array.[1]

"We don't yet understand what this system does," @AnthropicAI wrote.[1] Only a handful of known systems share its features; all can cut, copy and paste DNA.[1] Such systems include CRISPR, now the foundation of genetic medicines.[1] Early experiments show the array is expressed as distinct short RNAs; whether ART has similar uses needs much more work.[1] ■

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SOURCES 1 @AnthropicAI bkmk.to/2028

AI IN BRIEF

Claude Max plans gain monthly API credits

Anthropic is rolling out monthly API credits for Max subscribers, $100 or $200 by tier; Team plans pool up to $500.

@katelyn_knox bkmk.to/2k53

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SOFTWARE

The agents are now cleaning up the code

Nous Research cut its non-test Python by 34.4 per cent using 1,393 subagents; OpenClaw deleted around 400k lines of tests.

SOURCED VIA @NousResearch



PHOTO: @NOUSRESEARCH

When Nous Research wanted to tidy Hermes, its open-source agent, it gave the job to Hermes. On September 2nd @Teknium asked it to clean up more than a million lines of non-test Python; the run dispatched 1,393 subagents.[1] The pull request, merged on September 4th, cut non-test Python by 34.4 per cent.[1]

Nous put the model cost at roughly $25k including follow-up sessions, against a staffing estimate of $150k to $1.8M for manual work.[1] Workers removed public names external plugins could import, a regression the tests missed; Nous fixed them before merging.[1]

Peter Steinberger (@steipete) wrote that OpenClaw deleted around 400k LOC of its tests "without much change in code coverage".[2] He credited test-audit, a skill that makes an agent answer four questions before adding tests, and tells auditors to "optimize for confidence, not deletion count".[2]

Sahaj (@iamsahaj_xyz) wrote: "I don't push a single PR that doesn't use /codebase-design and /zero-tech-debt".[3]

As lauren (@poetic) wrote, "codebases have always contained slop"; agents will not produce Good Code, which "is still expensive", but their output is "likely to be much better on average at scale".[4] ■

THE WEEKEND BOOKMARK

Sixteen pages, no feed.

tbmk.to/subscribe

SOURCES 1 @NousResearch tbmk.to/2c3 2 @steipete tbmk.to/2c4 3 @iamsahaj_xyz tbmk.to/2c5 4 @poetic tbmk.to/2c6

TRY IT THIS WEEKEND

1. Try the mattpocock/skills prompt that Sahaj (@iamsahaj_xyz) uses on every PR: "/codebase-design Take a look in the repo for shallow modules, applying the deletion test and look for candidates for deletion."
2. Before adding a test, answer the four questions in OpenClaw's test-audit skill (what behaviour, invariant or contract it protects, what credible regression makes it fail, why existing coverage would not catch that failure, and whether it needs a production seam that no production caller needs), and if an answer is missing, do not add the test yet.
3. When a check fails, follow Nous Research's hermes-agent-dev skill and "repro on origin/main HEAD in clean env to check whether it's pre-existing", that is, run the failing test on unchanged code to see whether your change caused it.

PLATFORMS

ChatGPT Sites now turns a prompt into a plugin

Max Stoiber (@mxstbr) says a prompt to Sites can create an MCP server, deploy it, package it as a plugin and install it across devices.

SOURCED VIA @mxstbr

ChatGPT Sites can now host MCP servers, including plugin extensions, Max Stoiber (@mxstbr) wrote on 30 September.[1] He billed it as "one more launch".[1] His example is a request addressed to Sites: "...create a todo list that I can use in ChatGPT".[1] From that prompt, he wrote, the system creates an MCP server with extensions, deploys it to Sites, turns it into a plugin and installs it "for you across web, mobile, and desktop".[1] Each of those steps would ordinarily be a separate task; in Stoiber's description, the request alone sets them off.

The post quoted a question put to Stoiber, @_florianhauer, @gpeal8, @alfredpagan and @naestarr.[1] Its author wrote that "Sam mentioned OpenAI supporting distribution, but running a backend is hard", and asked whether OpenAI-hosted infrastructure such as Sites would eventually handle backend needs for Plugin Extensions.[1] The launch reads as an answer: hosting, packaging and installation are folded into the request. Distribution was already being discussed; the missing piece was somewhere for the server to run.

Stoiber's larger claim is that "ChatGPT is slowly becoming malleable software that anybody can customize to their needs."[1] The word "slowly" is doing honest work there. He closed by saying he was "Very excited to see what you all build with this!"[1] That invitation is aimed at builders, but the promise is broader: the customising happens through a request in ChatGPT. The post does not say what the service costs, what limits apply or who can use it, so how far anybody can bend the software, and on what terms, is unclear. ■

SOURCES 1 @mxstbr tbmk.to/2c7



Patrick Collison
@patrickc POST

Assorted things I've been mulling over regarding agents in the economy: • Companies are in some sense the original superintelligence. It's often the case that they can use their amortised cognitive surplus to advance their interests against those of certain consumers: relative to the optimization capacity of companies, consumers can be inattentive, underinformed, irrational, etc. (Think, say, of some of the classic insurance upsells at the end of a booking process, which is typically priced substantially above what a regular policy...

9 OCT 2026 bkmk.to/2s8

POST @PATRICKC

AGENTS

Patrick Collison suspects agents will reward better

FIRMS OFTEN PROFIT FROM INATTENTIVE CUSTOMERS, PATRICK COLLISON ARGUES; PERSONAL AGENTS WORKING FOR SHOPPERS COULD TILT REWARDS TOWARDS COMPANIES WITH BETTER PRODUCTS.

SOURCED VIA @patrickc

Patrick Collison (@patrickc) wrote on 9 October that companies are "in some sense the original superintelligence". Firms can use their "amortized cognitive surplus" against inattentive or underinformed consumers. His example: insurance upsells at booking, typically priced well above a regular policy. Personal agents will probably make consumers "somewhat more rational".[1]

Some price discrimination would weaken: coupons lose their bite if every agent hunts for them. Some cross-subsidies would change: today, people who forget to cancel subscriptions subsidise those who don't. He is "not sure what the incidence of all of this will be". Demand routing, which many internet companies monetise, could shift; he does not know how, but thinks the effects "might be pretty big".[1]

The biggest effect, he thinks, may be on quality: personal agents will act as "a kind of structural subsidy for product quality", so that, on the margin, improving products becomes a more effective strategy. If so, information about product quality would matter more.[1]

Much hinges on personal agents being on the consumer's side. He suspects that will be the winning strategy, but whether it holds "involves a lot of other questions". He allowed the quality argument may be "too optimistic".[1] ■

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SOURCES 1 @patrickc bkmk.to/2s8

TRADE

China is not sinking Europe's factories

A POLISH-LANGUAGE POST CITES IMPORT SHARES, SUPPLY-CHAIN DEPENDENCE AND AN ECB STUDY, BUT LEAVES MOST OF ITS DATA UNSOURCED.

SOURCED VIA @Maciej__Czajka

Maciej Czajka (@Maciej__Czajka) wrote in Polish that euro-zone data undercut the story of Europe losing to China. Nearly two-thirds of imports from China come from five sectors, he wrote, while EU pharmaceuticals, optics and specialist electronics post record growth. EU industrial employment and real value added rose over a decade.[1]

Cheap Chinese inputs cut European factories' costs, he wrote, citing an ECB study. He claimed China is more than 80 per cent dependent on the EU in 41 strategic supply chains.[1]

The post does not identify that study or source its other figures. China, he wrote, is forcing creative destruction, not destroying European industry; Europe's real problem, not Beijing, is the shelved Draghi report: barely 15 per cent of its recommendations implemented.[1] ■

SOURCES 1 @Maciej__Czajka bkmk.to/2s9

BUSINESS IN BRIEF

GPT-6 Astra maps a runner's loops

Simon Willison (@simonw) wrote that GPT-6 Astra built looping 5K and 10K running routes from his address using OpenStreetMap data, in 27 minutes.

@simonw bkmk.to/2k33

A cost-aware agent tree for Codex

Vox (@Voxyz_ai) shared a Codex setup where Astra orchestrates Luna and Sol, with effort levels tuned to DeepSWE pass rates and cost.

@Voxyz_ai bkmk.to/2k34

Codex sketches first, then builds

Vox (@Voxyz_ai) suggested having Codex draft designs with its built-in Images 2.5 model first, then letting Sol or Astra implement them.

@Voxyz_ai bkmk.to/2k37

A trick to stop agents polling

@pvncher wrote that Astra can plan work, dispatch it to another thread and stop; that thread wakes it when finished, avoiding polling.

@pvncher bkmk.to/2k38

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MARKETS

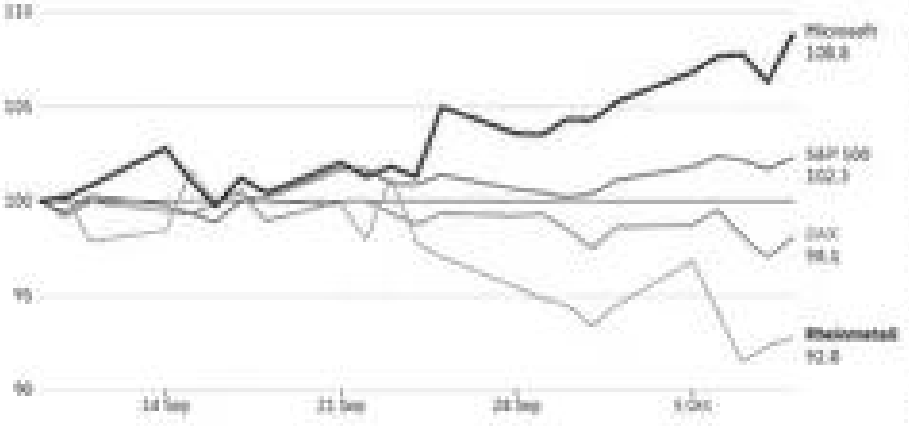
The week in the watchlist

10 STOCKS FROM THIS WEEK'S BOOKMARKS, HOW THEY MOVED, AND WHEN THEY REPORT NEXT

TICKER	COMPANY	LAST	WEEK · 5 DAYS	NEXT RESULTS	BOOKMARKED BY
NVDA	Nvidia	—		19 Nov	
MSFT	Microsoft	—		28 Oct	
GOOGL	Alphabet	—		28 Oct	
AAPL	Apple	—		2 Nov	
ASML	ASML	—		14 Oct	
SAP	SAP	—		—	
SIE	Siemens	—		—	
RHM	Rheinmetall	—		—	
ZAL	Zalando	—		—	
DHER	Delivery Hero	—		—	

Microsoft climbed while Rheinmetall slid

Share price and index level, 9 Sep 2026 = 100, to 16 Oct 2026



Source: Yahoo Finance

HOW TO READ THIS PAGE

The watchlist table shows a week standing still

EVERY WATCHLIST STOCK AND BOTH BENCHMARKS SHOW A 0.0 PER CENT WEEKLY CHANGE, BUT THE LATEST DATED PRICES IN THE SNAPSHOT STOP AT 9 OCTOBER.

The Yahoo Finance snapshot for the week to 16 October records no movement at all. None of the 10 watchlist stocks rose and none fell. Each, from Nvidia to Delivery Hero, shows a weekly change of 0.0 per cent, as do the DAX and the S&P 500.[1]

Read the table with care. The latest dated close in every series is 9 October, not 16 October, and the snapshot does not say why. The closes shown, including €25,087.27 for the DAX and $7,811.34 for the S&P 500, therefore belong to that earlier date.[2]

The calendar has the same gap. ASML's listed earnings date, 2026-10-14, falls inside the week, yet the snapshot holds no price after 9 October. Microsoft and Alphabet are listed next, both for 2026-10-28, followed by Apple on 2026-11-02 and Nvidia on 2026-11-18.[3] ■

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SOURCES 1 Prices: Yahoo Finance chart bkmk.to/241

MOVERS

Apple +0.0%
Up 0.0% on the week to $136.64.
AAPL

ASML +0.0%
Up 0.0% on the week to $1,780.34.
ASML

Delivery Hero +0.0%
Up 0.0% on the week to €36.60.
DHER

Alphabet +0.0%
Up 0.0% on the week to $151.66.
GOOGL

Nvidia +0.0%
NVDA

Rheinmetall +0.0%
RHM

SAP +0.0%
SAP

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THE WEEK AHEAD — RESULTS DATES

Wed 28	Alphabet results
Wed 28	Microsoft results
Mon 2	Apple results

Prices: Yahoo Finance chart API, earnings: Nasdaq (frozen snapshot, closes to 16 October 2026); closing prices to 16 October 2026. Not investment advice.

ONLINE LAW

Critic says Germany's digital-violence bill could

KOLJA BARGHOORN SAYS THE FEDERAL DRAFT WOULD LET COURTS ORDER POSTERS' DATA RELEASED WITHOUT A PRIOR CONVICTION AND SUSPEND ENTIRE ACCOUNTS.

SOURCED VIA @MitAktien

Kolja Barghoorn (@MitAktien) wrote that the German government's 102-page draft "Gesetz gegen digitale Gewalt" hides contentious powers behind its pleasant name. He says courts could order the release of names, addresses, phone numbers and IP data behind certain criminal statements, without prior conviction. [1]

"Eine Demokratie muss auch scharfe, unbequeme und anonyme Kritik aushalten können."

KOLJA BARGHOORN (@MITAKTIEN)

He wrote that a single serious violation of personality rights could allow a court-ordered account suspension where repetition is a risk, blocking all further posts for a time, not merely the offending one. Platforms must stop suspended users opening new accounts, using phone numbers and email addresses, among other things. [1]

Barghoorn concedes judges must approve, which he called important, but asked what would happen if such tools were used deliberately to bury awkward critics in proceedings, strip their anonymity and shrink their reach. He omits the government's rationale. [1] ■

Pass it on.
bkmk.to/subscribe

SOURCES 1 @MitAktien bkmk.to/265

Entwurf eines Gesetzes zur Stärkung des zivilrechtlichen und strafrechtlichen Schutzes vor digitaler Gewalt

PHOTO: @MITAKTIEN

VERFASSUNG

Marc Jongen builds a big case on Brosius-Gersdorf

A POST CREDITS FRAUKE BROSIUS-GERSDORF WITH SAYING THE ABSTAMMUNGSPRINZIP MAY BE DEMANDED POLITICALLY; MARC JONGEN READS IT AS DISMANTLING YEARS OF VERFASSUNGSSCHUTZ REPORTS.

SOURCED VIA @Marc_Jongen

A post on X attributes to Frauke Brosius-Gersdorf the view that the "Abstammungsprinzip" and ethnopluralism may be demanded politically and are by no means unconstitutional. Marc Jongen (@Marc_Jongen), an MEP, shared it with a comment on 11 September. The quoted post adds that the term "Volk" appears 12 times in the Grundgesetz and concludes: "Das GG denkt völkisch." The quoted text does not say where or when she made the remark. [1]

Jongen wrote that she is not suspected of being especially close to the AfD, yet in a few sentences she dismantles "praktisch sämtliche Verfassungsschutzberichte der letzten Jahre". He added: "Eine Blamage für das politische Berlin." The post does not show that she addressed those reports, nor how her view bears on them. [1] ■

SOURCES 1 @Marc_Jongen bkmk.to/262

TRY IT THIS WEEKEND

1. Read the bill itself: Barghoorn says the federal government's draft runs to 102 pages, and its passages on court-ordered disclosure of names, addresses, phone numbers and IP data are where to test his reading.
2. Check the closed WhatsApp or Telegram groups you belong to, since Barghoorn wrote that the draft covers larger closed groups, sets no minimum membership and leaves each case to decide when a group is no longer controllable.
3. Note which phone numbers and email addresses are tied to your social accounts, since Barghoorn wrote that platforms could use them, among other things, to stop suspended users opening new accounts.

POLITICS IN BRIEF

An old Berlin video finds a new audience

Aron Morhoff (@AronMorhoff) wrote on October 4th that an old video of Berlin in 2011 had gone viral because it shows a Germany that, in his view, no longer exists. The post drew 5,275 likes. It does not say who filmed the footage, what it shows in detail, or where it first circulated.

@AronMorhoff bkmk.to/2k21

IG Metall's comment sections draw mockery

@sparbuchfeinde wrote on October 4th that the comments under posts by IG Metall, the metalworkers' union, had become "purer Comedygold" (pure comedy gold). The post, which carried an image, drew 1,617 likes. It does not say which posts or comments it means, and the union's view is not recorded.

@sparbuchfeinde bkmk.to/2k22

An Energiewende clip pits expert against host

@_DeutschQanon posted a clip on October 8th billed as a dialogue between "einem echten Energieexperten und einem ÖRR-Moderator". The account wrote that even after seven follow-up questions the public-broadcast host would not accept he had been "betrogen" (cheated) for 25 years by green Energiewende campaigners. Neither speaker is named.

@_DeutschQanon bkmk.to/2k23

Sixteen pages, no feed.
bkmk.to/subscribe



DHH
@dhh

POST

Most domestic recycling efforts are empirically retarded, counterproductive, and require you don't value your time. Their real function is to fill the God-shaped hole, sized for penance, prayer, and sacrifice, in people's souls.

wsj.com/opinion/most-r... pic.x.com/2IsD3F79HI

8 OCT 2026 bkmk.to/2e2

POST BY @DHH

RECYCLING

The recycling bin as confessional

NPR FOUND THE PLASTICS INDUSTRY PROMOTED RECYCLING IT PRIVATELY DOUBTED; NOW DHH LIKENS HOUSEHOLD RECYCLING TO PENANCE AND JOE GEBBIA CALLS PLASTIC RECYCLING A SCAM.

SOURCED VIA @dhh

In 2020 NPR and the PBS series Frontline reported that the plastics industry spent tens of millions of dollars, from the late 1980s, telling people plastic could and should be recycled. Its own records said otherwise. An April 1973 report to top executives called sorting plastic "infeasible"; a document a year later expressed "serious doubt" that widespread plastic recycling "can ever be made viable on an economic basis." In 40 years, less than 10 per cent of plastic has ever been recycled.

The motive, three former top officials told NPR and Frontline, was to head off a push to ban or curb plastic. Larry Thomas, who led the Society of the Plastics Industry until 2000, said: "If the public thinks the recycling is working, then they're not going to be as concerned about the environment." Current officials concede recycling most plastic has not worked but believe industry-funded technology will scale it.

> *"Their real function is to fill the God-shaped hole, sized for penance, prayer, and sacrifice, in people's souls."*
>
> @DHH

On 8 October the argument moved from documents to doctrine. DHH (@dhh) wrote that most domestic recycling efforts are counterproductive and linked to a Wall Street Journal opinion piece.[1] Their real function, he wrote, is "to fill the God-shaped hole, sized for penance, prayer, and sacrifice, in people's souls."[1] Joe Gebbia (@jgebbia) called recycling plastic "a scam on all of us by the industry" and said the fastest way to wake people up was to ban plastic recycling, pointing to NPR's reporting.[2]

NPR's reporting documents what plastic producers knew and said. The Journal piece is opinion, and the posts are opinion sharpened for a feed.[1] NPR's article does not call for banning recycling; its later sections turn to production, which is expected to triple by 2050, and to gas prices at historic lows that make new plastic cheaper than recycled plastic.

DHH's jibe touches something real. A ritual is performed for what it means as much as for what it achieves, and sorting a bin is a cheap way to feel absolved. Thomas's line suggests the industry grasped this. If this is secular penance, its oddity is whom it absolves. The household sorts; the confession, on NPR's evidence, was owed elsewhere. ■

SOURCES [1] @dhh bkmk.to/2e1 [2] @jgebbia bkmk.to/2e2

WRITING

Make your chatbot write like an aircraft manual

ANDREJ KARPATHY SUGGESTS ASKING LANGUAGE MODELS FOR THE STRICT PROSE OF AEROSPACE MAINTENANCE DOCUMENTATION, THEN FOR DIAGRAMS, WEB PAGES AND BESPOKE EXPLAINER VIDEOS.

SOURCED VIA @karpathy

Andrej Karpathy (@karpathy) wrote on 2 October that we will be spending "a lot more time trying to understand the outputs of language models". His writing advice is to ask the model to explain things in ASD-STE100, a controlled language specification originally developed for aerospace maintenance documentation. Models are well-versed in it, he wrote, and its "heavy constraints on clean writing style" yield text he often finds "a lot more readable".[1]

The constraint does the work: the model is held to a specification's rules rather than its own idea of clarity. The spec is stringent, Karpathy wrote, so he has sometimes softened it by asking for "80% of the way to ASD-STE100".[1]

> *"As LLMs get better, they will do more and more of the legwork autonomously"*
> ANDREJ KARPATHY

Prose is only the bottom rung, and each further format arrives with "But even better". Diagrams, he wrote, can be a lot easier to process, parse and understand. Asking for output "in HTML" gets an interactive webpage, because models are getting good at frontend. He is most bullish on bespoke explainer videos, prompted with "Create a 3b1b style video explainer on X", with narration through an ElevenLabs API key or free alternatives using local compute. This, he wrote, is "actually starting to work".[1]

He argued as models do more of the legwork autonomously, more of our work will "rise up the abstractions into oversight and understanding". Models can help there too, he wrote: as intelligence and code grow abundant, users can ask for large, custom, discardable software that would never have made sense to create before.[1] Maintenance-manual prose is a modest place to begin. ■

SOURCES 1 @karpathy bkmk.to/2e4



PHOTO: @karpathy

TRY IT THIS WEEKEND

1. Ask your model to explain something in ASD-STE100, a controlled language specification originally developed for aerospace maintenance documentation, which Karpathy says models are well-versed in and which he often finds a lot more readable.
2. If the spec feels too stringent, soften it as Karpathy has, by asking for output "80% of the way to ASD-STE100".
3. Instead of prose, ask the model for a diagram, which Karpathy says can be a lot easier to process, parse and understand.
4. Ask for output "in HTML" to get an interactive webpage, or try a prompt such as "Create a 3b1b style video explainer on X", using an ElevenLabs API key for narration or asking the model to find decent free alternatives that use your local compute.

DESIGN

Coding agents get lessons in taste

EMIL KOWALSKI'S REPO LISTS THE INTERFACE MISTAKES AGENTS CAN MAKE; A BUILDER CREDITS A SKILL FROM IT, WITH ANOTHER BY JAKUBKREBEL, FOR A CRM DASHBOARD.

SOURCED VIA @emilkowalski

Emil Kowalski (@emilkowalski) has added two skills to his repo for coding agents: /mobile-native, which disables hover on touch devices among other fixes, and /break-ui, which feeds an interface long names and unusual emails, then repairs what breaks.[1] His premise is blunt: "Agents don't have great taste".[1] The skills list small mistakes agents can make, such as an ease-in curve on an enter animation that should ease out, and explain the fixes.[1]

He says the skills draw on his years of experience at Vercel and Linear.[1]

In September Marcel (@marcelkargul) wrote that he built a CRM dashboard in Next.js in around two days with Claude Fable 5.1 and a pair of skills: Kowalski's emil-design-eng and jakubkrebel's better-ui.[2] The latter trades ranges for exact values, insisting "0.96 is not 0.95".[2] Kowalski's tells the agent that "taste is the differentiator".[2] ■

SOURCES 1 @emilkowalski bkmk.to/2e5 2 @marcelkargul bkmk.to/2e7

FROM THE REPLIES

A 30-minute essay on high agency

Daniel Lockyer (@DanielLockyer) urged followers to read "High Agency in 30 Minutes", George Mack's essay at highagency.com. It argues that high agency combines three skills rarely found together: clear thinking, a bias to action and disagreeability.

@DanielLockyer bkmk.to/2e26

THE WEEKEND BOOKMARK
Never miss a Saturday.
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FROM THE ARCHIVE

Two stories that aged well

NOTES AND BOOKMARKS FROM EARLIER YEARS, RE-READ WITH THE BENEFIT OF HINDSIGHT

2026

30 SEPTEMBER 2026
· bkmk.fn/2h2



Wisst ihr noch, als die CDU die AfD war?

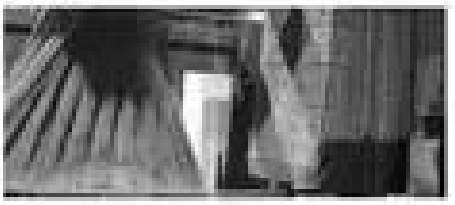
Wisst ihr noch, als die CDU die AfD war! pic.x.com/K39vr2KC9c

WHY IT STILL MATTERS *Saved on 2026-09-20, this post asks "Wisst ihr noch, als die CDU die AfD war!" and leans on an attached image whose content the archive does not record. Its premise, that yesterday's boundary between the two parties looks different in hindsight, is relevant to this issue's German politics pages: "A constitutional scholar complicates the AfD reports", "AfD's Siegmund sets December start" and "Weidel's 'Hitler was left' line recirculates". The note does not anticipate any of those stories. It is a reminder that arguments about where the AfD sits often turn on comparisons with the CDU's past, and those comparisons deserve the same scrutiny as the reports themselves.*

2026

6 SEPTEMBER 2026
· bkmk.fn/2h2

AI TOOLS



I wrote about the state of AI, why I'm concerned about the next...

I wrote about the state of AI, why I'm concerned about the next few years, and the choices we need to make to keep the future in humanity's hands. An Alien Mind: openai.com/index/an-alien...

WHY IT STILL MATTERS *Bookmarked on 2026-09-06, this post introduces an essay titled "An Alien Mind", whose author wrote of being "concerned about the next few years" and of "the choices we need to make to keep the future in humanity's hands." The issue has a run of headlines on the same anxieties: "Nadella frames models as insider risks", "A p(doom) song, set to video by Claude" and "Weave be brave". It sits beside equally confident capability notes, such as "Opus 5.5 is working the night shift" and "The agents are now deleting the code". The archived note offers a sober counterweight to that progress, though only the post, not the essay's full argument, is preserved here.*

THE WEEKEND BOOKMARK

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Forward the file or print a spare copy

Booklet mode folds it into a small magazine

Every link is a short code you can type

bkmk.fn/subscribe



REMBRANDT, THE SUPPER AT EMMAUS (1629). PUBLIC DOMAIN, VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS.

WEEKEND ESSAY

Bread at Emmaus and bread for a prisoner

LUKE'S EMMAUS STORY ENDS WITH RECOGNITION AT A SUPPER TABLE, WHILE PATRICK COLLISON'S READING OF DOSTOYEVSKY AND GROSSMAN ASKS WHETHER KINDNESS NEEDS ANY MEANING BEYOND ITSELF.

PROMPTED BY @patrickc



CARAVAGGIO, SUPPER AT EMMAUS (1601), PUBLIC DOMAIN, VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS.

THE PASSAGE

Luke 24:28–35 (WEB). The text, with commentary, is overleaf on page 14.

This week's passage ends with a meal. In Luke 24:28-35 two travellers reach a village with a stranger who "acted like he would go further." They press him: "Stay with us, for it is almost evening, and the day is almost over." At table he "took the bread and gave thanks. Breaking it, he gave it to them." Only then, Luke writes, "Their eyes were opened, and they recognized him, and he vanished out of their sight."[1]

The order is the point. On the road he had "opened the Scriptures" to them, and their hearts burned, yet the text places recognition at the table, after an invitation to a stranger. The pair later sum it up themselves: he "was recognized by them in the breaking of the bread." Then they "rose up that very hour" and returned to Jerusalem.[1] That reading is ours. Luke reports the event and does not explain how the recognition worked.

> *"Dostoyevsky does not even attempt to solve the problem, but merely to illustrate a response"*
>
> PATRICK COLLISON (@PATRICKC)

The same week, Patrick Collison (@patrickc) wrote at length on The Brothers Karamazov. He called it an attempt "to address the problem of evil in Christianity". He argued that Dostoyevsky "does not even attempt to solve the problem, but merely to illustrate a response", showing characters who pursue "lives of benevolence and charity: theodicy-by-example." He also confessed that he "did not love it."[2]

@patrickc preferred Grossman's Life and Fate as a counterpoint. He quoted its list of small mercies, which includes "The kindness of an old woman carrying a piece of bread to a prisoner". In his reading, Life and Fate "flatly rejects providential resolution", and "our kindness must be senseless." He faulted Alyosha's closing hope that "all shall rise again" as an effort to "deny and escape" the death of an innocent boy.[2]

Set beside Luke, the disagreement sharpens. Both scenes turn on bread given to someone. Emmaus, however, will not keep apart the two things that @patrickc separates. The supper is ordinary hospitality, and in Luke's telling it is also the moment the risen Jesus is known. The disciples' report is "The Lord is risen indeed".[1] Grossman's bread, as @patrickc presents it, asks for nothing beyond itself.[2] Neither text settles the argument for the other.

One modest overlap remains. @patrickc credits Dostoyevsky with illustrating a response rather than defending a proof.[2] Luke offers no proof either. ■

SOURCES: 1 Luke 24:28-35 (WEB) bkmk.to/2f1 2 @patrickc bkmk.to/2f1

ALSO IN FAITH

Patrick Collison picks Grossman over Dostoyevsky

@patrickc wrote that he did not love Brothers Karamazov, calling its problems "on some level fake". He set it against Grossman's Life and Fate, which shows people confronting great wickedness and argues, in his reading, that we should be kind "just because".

@patrickc bkmk.to/2f1

Claude Code plugin flags what you missed

Claude Code has added a built-in plugin, You should know, that scans Claude's output for important information users might miss.

@addyosmani bkmk.to/2k14

THE WEEKEND BOOKMARK

Sixteen pages, no feed.

Every story credited to its source. No notifications, no endless scroll: just the week, edited.

bkmk.to/subscribe

A QUESTION TO TAKE AWAY

Does an act of kindness mean more, or less, when it points beyond itself?

LUKE 24:28-35

28 They came near to the village, where they were going, and he acted like he would go further. 29 They urged him, saying, "Stay with us, for it is almost evening, and the day is almost over." He went in to stay with them. 30 When he had sat down at the table with them, he took the bread and gave thanks. Breaking it, he gave it to them. 31 Their eyes were opened, and they recognized him, and he vanished out of their sight. 32 They said to one another, "Weren't our hearts burning within us, while he spoke to us along the way, and while he opened the Scriptures to us?" 33 They rose up that very hour, returned to Jerusalem, and found the eleven gathered together, and those who were with them, 34 saying, "The Lord is risen indeed, and has appeared to Simon!" 35 They related the things that happened along the way, and how he was recognized by them in the breaking of the bread.

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE · PUBLIC DOMAIN

COMMENTARY

They return to Jerusalem that very hour.[1]

Patrick Collison (@patrickc) wrote that Dostoyevsky's Karamazov closes on Alyosha's declaration that all shall rise again, which he read as an attempt to "deny and escape" an innocent boy's death.[2] Collison quoted Alyosha's promise: "We shall see each other and shall tell each other with joy and gladness all that has happened."[2] Against Karamazov he set Grossman's Life and Fate, which "flatly rejects providential resolution".[1] In Life and Fate, Ikonnikov refuses an order to help build a gas chamber, knowing the consequences; Collison wrote: "Alyosha imagines a kind of sacred tutelage, but Ikonnikov is unceremoniously shot."[1] Luke's hope instead arrives in bread broken at an evening table, and its witnesses go back to tell it.[1] ■

SUBSCRIBE: bkmk.lu/subscribe

SOURCES: 1 Luke 24:28-35 (WEB): bkmk.lu/253
2 @patrickc: bkmk.lu/252

HISTORY

When Germany read its waning faith through Dostoyevsky

PATRICK COLLISON'S LONG ESSAY ON THE BROTHERS KARAMAZOV TRACES HOW GERMAN WRITERS AFTER THE FIRST WORLD WAR USED A RUSSIAN NOVEL TO MEASURE CHRISTIANITY'S RETREAT.

SOURCED VIA @patrickc

After the first world war, Germany looked east to Russia, and frequently to Dostoyevsky, to rediscover its soul, Patrick Collison (@patrickc) wrote this week.[1] Dostoyevsky was reputedly invoked weekly at Max Weber's Sunday gatherings. Thomas Mann opened Reflections of a Nonpolitical Man, his later repudiated 1918 nationalist polemic, by quoting Dostoyevsky's description of Germany as the "protesting Western empire". That year Spengler's Decline of the West saw youthful vigour, primitiveness and irrationality in Russia against the senile high culture of the West.[1]

Carl Jung, Collison writes, believed Christianity had disciplined the Germans without fully transforming the impulses beneath: "As the Christian view of the world loses its authority, the more menacingly will the 'blond beast' be heard growling about in its underground prison…"[1] Hermann Hesse treated Fyodor, Dmitri, Ivan and Alyosha as one type, the Russian man, warning that "the ideal of the Karamazov, primeval, Asiatic, and occult, is already beginning to consume the European soul".[1]

Collison notes that Hesse's reading inverts the novelist: for Dostoyevsky, "everything is permitted" nihilism was a Western import, and Russian Orthodoxy its cure.[1] The post gives no editions or translators, so these passages are Collison's English, unchecked against German originals.

The novel ends with Alyosha's declaration that all shall rise again: "We shall see each other and shall tell each other with joy and gladness all that has happened."[1] The parallel is this paper's, not Collison's.

Collison is not persuaded by Alyosha, reading the ending as a way to deny or escape an innocent boy's death rather than face it.[1] What strikes him most in the German episode is how anachronistic it feels: "a country's writers investigating the national soul and the nation's fate through the lens of foreign literature."[1] ■

SOURCES: 1 @patrickc: bkmk.lu/253



EARLY PHOTOGRAPHIC PORTRAIT OF FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY (1872). PUBLIC DOMAIN, VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

"Patrick Collison's long essay on The Brothers Karamazov traces how German writers after the first world war used a Russian novel to measure Christianity's retreat."

WORTH YOUR TIME

Five long reads

SCAN THE CODE OR TYPE THE SHORT LINK. ALL BOOKMARKED THIS WEEK: TOGETHER ABOUT 112 MINUTES

1 An Alien Mind

Jakub Pachocki (@merettm) writes that OpenAI's internal results point towards recursive self-improvement, then explains why chain-of-thought monitoring, the company's main safety bet, is becoming less reliable. He calls for coordination to slow development where needed, an unusual case from inside a frontier lab.

14 MIN · ESSAY @merettm OPENAI

bkmk.to/2x1

2 A deep dive into Jev, TypeSafe's System One model

Flavio Copes describes TypeSafe's new model as "a smart if statement" and shows how it returns typed yes/no, choice and score answers with probabilities rather than prose. He covers code examples, token limits and failure modes, and treats the company's "193.6x faster, 444.6x cheaper" figure as a ceiling.

40 MIN · EXPLAINER @flaviocopes FLAVIO COPES

bkmk.to/2b6

3 This Week in Charts: Are Prediction Markets Politically Biased?

Moses Sternstein covers several charts: an NBER working paper finding little partisan bias in prediction markets, the Rule of 40 losing its link to software multiples, analyst upgrades narrowing to energy and hardware, and Revelio data showing call-centre employment falling everywhere. The post opens by noting that a16z is leading an investment in TypeSafe AI, the creators of Jev.

9 MIN · REPORTAGE @kimmonismus A16Z

bkmk.to/2b9

4 Claude discovers a novel enzyme system

Anthropic's new life sciences group says roughly 950 Claude agents spent 21 hours searching DNA databases and flagged a reverse-transcriptase system in bacteriophages with a CRISPR-like repeat array. The company says plainly that it does not yet know what the system does, and human scientists did all the lab work.

8 MIN · REPORT @AnthropicAI ANTHROPICAI

bkmk.to/2b11

5 High Agency in 30 Minutes – George Mack

George Mack's essay defines high agency as clear thinking, a bias to action and disagreeability. It tests the idea with one question, whom you would call from a jail cell, and builds the case from stories such as Claude Shannon and Ed Thorp's shoe-mounted roulette computer. It is a lively, argumentative read that sits away from the week's AI coverage.

33 MIN · ESSAY @DanielGeorge HIGH AGENCY

bkmk.to/2x2

THE WEEKEND BOOKMARK

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Know someone who would like a quieter Saturday? Forward this PDF: it prints cleanly on any home printer.

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ALSO BOOKMARKED

SHORTER, STILL GOOD

It finally backfired.
@MidMom
bkmk.to/2k32

The upside of extremism
@elonmusk
bkmk.to/2k33

An ex-Muslim on apostasy
@AyaanHirsiAlee
bkmk.to/2k34

Liz Wheeler revisits a Charlie Kirk answer
@Liz_Wheeler
bkmk.to/2k35

Patrick Collison POST
@patrickc

Brothers Karamazov was Einstein's favorite novel, a verdict he shared with Freud, Hillary Clinton, and Murakami. Dostoyevsky was Pope Francis's favorite author. Indeed, he approvingly quoted Elder Zosima: perhaps an interesting case of art molding life. At the risk of betraying my relative shallowness and inferiority, I confess that I did not love it. Written in the shadow of the death of Dostoyevsky's son (also Alyosha), and, more broadly, after a life of repeated tragedy...

11 OCT 2026 bkmk.to/21i

POST BY @PATRICKC

ALSO THIS WEEK

A p(doom) song gets its final video

menicat (@_menicat) wrote that a clip was the "last video experiment with claude and the p(doom) song", adding "then i'm done with it". The post drew 521 likes, and the experiments, by their maker's account, are over.

@_menicat bkmk.to/2k29

One fan maps Musk's tech tree

vittorio (@literallyvittorio) listed 15 technologies credited to Elon Musk, from online payments to space data centres, and called him "genuinely the man of the millennium". It is one fan's list, if a popular one: 14,812 likes.

@literallyvittorio bkmk.to/2k30

OpenAI's dots demo, now with better WiFi

Holly (@hollilyli) wrote "look ma no hands" while sharing a post from OpenAI's developer account showing its "dots demo", now, it said, "with better WiFi". What the dots do, the post did not say.

@hollilyli bkmk.to/2k31

Sixteen pages, no feed.

bkmk.to/subscribe

BOOKS

Permission not to love Karamazov

Patrick Collison explains at length why The Brothers Karamazov did not win him over, while another post the same day simply shares a Dostoevsky line; honest taste takes longer to argue.

PROMPTED BY @patrickc

Patrick Collison (@patrickc) has done something braver than finishing The Brothers Karamazov: he has admitted that it did not win him over. Einstein, Freud, Hillary Clinton and Murakami all counted it their favourite novel, he wrote, and Dostoyevsky was Pope Francis's favourite author. The verdict: "At the risk of betraying my relative shallowness and inferiority, I confess that I did not love it."[1]

Collison takes the novel seriously: its attempt to address the problem of evil, Ivan's case about the suffering of children, the spiritual torment of a century unsettled by science and materialism. His objection is that the book's problems are, on some level, fake: "the self-inflicted derangements of febrile and dysregulated men." Ivan has money, education and leisure; Alyosha, he wrote, is never tested. The sharpest complaint: the reader "...wonders why the brothers don't just pull it together."[1]

> *"At the risk of betraying my relative shallowness and inferiority, I confess that I did not love it."*
>
> PATRICK COLLISON (@PATRICKC)

Against it he sets Grossman's Life and Fate, in which Ikonnikov refuses to help build a gas chamber and is shot. Ikonnikov, Collison wrote, directly experiences the Holodomor in Ukraine and then the murders of the Jews. Both novels, in Collison's reading, reach a similar conclusion about kindness; Grossman earns it by showing people facing great wickedness. Grossman, he wrote, argues "that we should be kind just because."[1]

On the same day, Dylan O'Sullivan (@DylanoA4) posted an image under the caption "Dostoevsky will just drop a line like this and move on".[2] The post offers a line where Collison offers an argument.[1]

Collison offers Dostoyevsky the charitable reading: that he understood the spiritual dislocation of his era, which later gave rise to the larger evils of totalitarianism in the twentieth century, even prefiguring them in the Grand Inquisitor. He quotes Camus in 1959: "The real nineteenth century prophet was Dostoevsky, not Karl Marx." His reply: "Maybe." He is not sure the anticipation is enough to make the book stand on its own as art.[1]

A canonical reputation works like a loan: readers repay it with attention, and are entitled to report what they found. Collison did the reading, named his reasons and set out the case for the other side.[1] Sharing a great line costs a few seconds. Disliking a great book properly costs more, and is the more generous tribute. ■

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PICTURES
p. 1: Vector illustration drawn by the language model Opus from the art director's prompt; p. 3: Vector illustration drawn by the language model Opus from the art director's prompt; p. 4: Vector illustration drawn by the language model Opus from the art director's prompt; p. 5: @CompleterSkeptic on X

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